

YouthWORY
NT

2025 Annual Report

NT Industry Training Bureau Inc.

ywnt.com.au

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Young people
living their
best lives

Acknowledgement of Country

YouthWorX NT acknowledges the Traditional Custodians of the lands on which we live, learn and work. We pay our respects to their Elders past and present and extend that respect to all Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples. We recognise their continuing connection to land, waters, culture and community and their invaluable contribution to our shared future.



About Us

YouthWorX NT partners with young people to shape their future and support them to live their best lives. Based in Darwin and now expanding our presence in Alice Springs, we work across the Northern Territory to provide inclusive, community-focused support for young people aged 15 to 25 through education, training, employment pathways and wellbeing initiatives.

We deliver practical, work-ready programs tailored to the changing needs of our community. Our programs are designed for all young people, equipping them with the skills, confidence and experience to thrive in the workplace.

OUR VISION
Young People **Living**
Their Best Lives.

OUR PURPOSE
Partnering with
young people to
shape their own future.

We also collaborate with industry and government agencies to promote inclusive practices and create meaningful employment opportunities.

Working alongside communities in both urban and regional settings, YouthWorX NT remains committed to social impact, advocating for young people and championing a future where every young Territorian can participate fully in their community.





Reflections on the year

A message from the Chair and CEO

2025 has been a year of deliberate growth, stronger connections and clear progress against our long-term vision. With the commencement of our 2025–2029 Strategic Plan, YouthWorX NT has focused on deepening our impact across the Northern Territory, while building the systems, partnerships and capability needed to sustain that impact into the future. Our work continues to be grounded in the voices and experiences of young people, ensuring that what we deliver is not only responsive, but genuinely meaningful.

This year, we strengthened our relationships across government, industry and community, creating more opportunities for young people to build skills and move towards work. Our collaboration with partners, alongside our ongoing engagement with employers, has supported more inclusive practices and improved pathways into employment.

A significant milestone in 2025 was the expansion of our presence into Alice Springs. Establishing a permanent footprint in Central Australia has allowed us to deliver more place-based support and build stronger connections with local communities.

This growth has been supported by investment in our workforce, systems and infrastructure, including the introduction of new roles and the implementation of our new client management system, strengthening how we track outcomes and deliver services.

We are particularly proud of the decision to self-fund the Career Launchpad program in 2025. In the absence of dedicated funding, the Board made a deliberate choice to continue the program, recognising the critical gap it fills for young people transitioning from school into employment. This decision came at a financial cost to the organisation, but reflects our shared commitment to ensuring young people are not left without support at a pivotal stage in their lives.

Across all programs, we have seen the tangible impact of this work. Young people are building confidence, gaining qualifications and moving into employment across a range of industries. Programs such as Encompass and Career Launchpad continue to demonstrate the value of tailored, consistent support, while CareerStart initiatives are creating clear pathways into in-demand industries aligned with workforce needs across the Territory.

Reflections on the year

continued...

We have also continued to elevate youth voice, ensuring young people are represented in local and national conversations. Their contributions through co-design and leadership opportunities are shaping not only our programs, but broader discussions around employment, inclusion and service delivery.

Recognition at both Territory and national levels, including award wins and nominations, reflects the strength of our approach and the commitment of our team. Behind every outcome is a group of dedicated staff who bring skill, care and persistence to their work each day. As we look ahead, our focus remains clear.

We will continue to strengthen our sustainability, expand our reach and advocate for systems that better support young people to transition from education to employment.

We thank our Board, staff, partners and funders for their ongoing commitment, and most importantly, the young people who place their trust in us. They are the reason we do this work.

Peter de Jonge

Chair, NT Industry Training Bureau

Michelle Barton

Chief Executive Officer, YouthWorX NT

OUR VALUES

CONNECTION

We build genuine relationships that empower young people to feel valued and part of a community.

PASSION

We have an unwavering commitment to our community, driven by a deep passion for equality, growth and opportunity.

HONESTY

We embrace transparency and authenticity in everything we do, fostering trust and understanding.

COURAGE

We are bold thinkers and risk takers who challenge the status quo.

2025-2029 Strategic Plan Progress

In 2025, YouthWorX NT began implementing our 2025–2029 Strategic Plan, with a strong focus on deepening community connections, strengthening organisational sustainability and amplifying the voices of young people across the Northern Territory.

GROWTH & INDEPENDENCE

Expand our reach for increased opportunities.

Grow and develop our team with **innovative pathways for opportunity, promotion, and leadership.**

Strengthen our foundations and execute strategies to **support sustainable growth.**

Identify and activate business opportunities that impact our community and provide **financial independence.**

2025 marked a period of significant organisational growth, with deliberate investment in people, systems, infrastructure and governance to support long-term sustainability.

We expanded our workforce across Darwin and Alice Springs, including the introduction of new roles to support the rollout of Inclusive Employment Australia (IEA). Coinciding with the commencement of IEA, YouthWorX NT established a permanent presence in Alice Springs, strengthening our ability to deliver place-based support and build meaningful connections across Central Australia.

Our workforce development model continued to create traineeship pathways for young people within YouthWorX NT, giving them the chance to gain real workplace experience and move towards meaningful careers.

The implementation of a new client management system, Flowlogic, strengthened our ability to track outcomes, improve service delivery and meet compliance requirements. In parallel, we introduced consistent evaluation tools across all programs, enabling more robust measurement of both tangible outcomes and personal growth for participants.

A major milestone was the transition to a single, shared Darwin premises, bringing together teams previously operating across multiple sites. This has improved collaboration, increased accessibility and positioned YouthWorX NT for future growth.

We also strengthened our position as a sector leader, contributing to policy discussions, pre-budget submissions and workforce planning initiatives to advocate for improved pathways for young people transitioning from education to employment.

OUR FOCUS AREAS & OBJECTIVES

CONNECT & AMPLIFY

Strengthen connections with a diverse range of stakeholders and decision-makers to increase opportunities.

Promote a culture in which **young peoples' voice and experience matters**.

Champion young peoples' skills and elevate community understanding to change the narrative.

Develop and **utilise data and evidence** to increase our impact.

YouthWorX NT continued to elevate the voices of young people and strengthen our influence across local and national platforms.

Young people played an active role in shaping initiatives, contributing through co-design processes, advisory groups and leadership opportunities. Representation on the NT Youth Round Table and the National Youth Employment Body Youth Advisory Board ensured that Territory perspectives were included in national conversations.

We maintained strong visibility across the sector, participating in national conferences, forums and working groups and contributing to discussions on inclusive employment, workforce development and service reform.

Our work was recognised through multiple awards and nominations, reflecting the strength of our programs and the impact of our approach. These achievements reinforce YouthWorX NT's role as a trusted partner and leader in youth employment and inclusion.

CREATING COMMUNITY

Create **safe and welcoming spaces**, where young people are engaged, understood, and belong.

Capture and value insights from young people, ensuring **their voices shape what we do**.

Apply **co-design principles** to projects aimed at improving outcomes for young Territorians.

Create **meaningful opportunities for youth involvement** across our organisation.

Throughout the year, YouthWorX NT strengthened relationships across government, industry and community to expand opportunities for young people and increase our collective impact.

We engaged with key stakeholders across government, including Ministers, senior advisors, departmental leaders and local decision-makers, ensuring youth perspectives informed policy and future investment. Partnerships with organisations, including the Australian Human Rights Commission, supported collaborative initiatives such as inclusive employment workshops and community events.

Our presence at major community events and forums across the Territory enabled direct engagement with young people, families, service providers and employers, while initiatives such as the NT Youth Employer Toolkit continued to build stronger pathways into work. The Toolkit was successfully launched in May and represents a key step in improving youth employment outcomes.

Youth voice remained central to this work. Young people shared their lived experiences through workshops, public speaking opportunities and advisory roles, influencing employer practices and contributing to broader community understanding of inclusive employment.

2025 Inspiration

"When young people are given the right support, they don't just find a pathway, they start to see what's possible."

Michelle Barton, CEO

103

Young people completed accredited training outcomes with us (including 66 white cards).

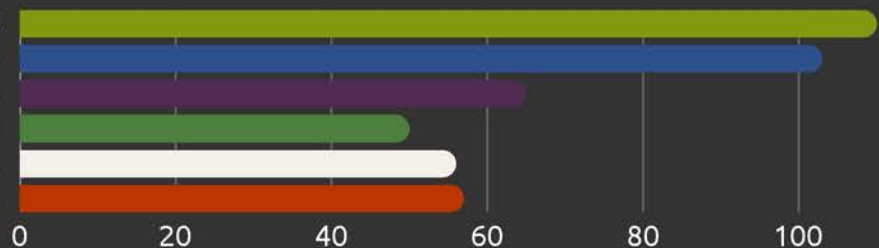
365+

Volunteering hours completed in the community.

150+

150 Workshops delivered inhouse at YouthWorX delivering independence and work readiness skills.

Young people supported
Accredited training outcomes
Employment outcomes
Work experience placements
Workplace and Industry Tours
Detention Centre visits



40+

Activities connecting with various community and organisations sharing their knowledge with our participants.

1500+

One-on-One personalised coaching sessions providing support, guidance and confidence to set goals, overcome challenges and to shape their own future.





Encompass Service

Empowering NDIS participants through personalised, employment-focused support.

- Participants gained skills and confidence to pursue employment or further education.
- Individualised support led to personal confidence, stronger wellbeing, independence, community connection and job readiness.

Encompass Service

Encompassing Futures: 2025 in Review

The Encompass program provides ongoing, tailored support for young people with disability and complex barriers to employment. Through a combination of workshops, coaching, volunteering, work experience and community engagement, participants build independence, social confidence and work readiness.

Throughout 2025, the program supported up to 30 participants at any given time, with a total of 46 young people engaged across the year.

Participants engaged in weekly skill-building workshops, one-on-one coaching, volunteering, work experience placements and a range of community and social activities. Workshop topics focused on practical life and employment skills, including budgeting, workplace expectations, communication, resume development and independent living skills such as renting and cooking.

Guest presenters from organisations including WorkSafe NT, Headspace, Consumer Affairs NT and the NT Working Women's Centre provided valuable insights into workplace rights and responsibilities.

Employment outcomes were particularly strong in 2025, with participants securing roles across retail, hospitality, trades and service industries. Employers included McDonald's, Metcash, Kmart, Perfect Paving, NT United Aircon & Maintenance, Equal Grounds, Heath Motor Group, Harry's Place Café, EB Games, NT Traffic Control and Power and Water Corporation, where one participant commenced an apprenticeship.

Several participants progressed into full-time employment or apprenticeships, while others secured casual roles that supported ongoing skill development and independence.

Work experience placements remained a key pathway to employment, with participants completing placements with organisations such as NT Fasteners, Kinetic IT, McDonald's, NT Fire and Emergency Service and the Department of Children and Families.

Training opportunities further supported participant development, with courses including Traffic Management, Retail Skill Sets, Certificate III in Information Technology, driver education and workplace skills training. These opportunities enabled participants to build practical qualifications and confidence entering the workforce.

Volunteering continued to play an important role, with participants contributing to organisations such as RSPCA, St Vinnies and Foodbank, as well as supporting community events including Darwin Festival, Seabreeze Festival and the Freds Pass Rural Show.

Community engagement activities, including the Friday Social Group, fishing outings, sporting activities and group excursions, supported social connection and strengthened peer relationships.

A standout highlight was the "Café for a Day" initiative, where participants planned and operated a café open to the public. Through this experience, they developed hands-on hospitality skills including food preparation, barista work, order taking and customer service. The initiative provided real-world experience, built confidence and showcased the capability of participants, with strong teamwork contributing to a highly successful event.

The Encompass program continues to demonstrate the value of long-term, personalised support in helping young people with disability build confidence, independence and meaningful pathways into employment and community participation.

Introducing Roanin

Roanin: Picking and Packing a Bright Future

Roanin joined the Encompass program in August 2023 with a goal to build his confidence in workplace settings. Through one-on-one coaching, volunteering, workshops, work experience and participation in initiatives such as "Café for a Day", he not only achieved this goal but grew into a capable and supportive leader.

Over time, Roanin began mentoring new participants, particularly during volunteering activities, offering guidance and encouragement that helped others feel comfortable and engaged.

His leadership and teamwork were also evident during the Couch Surfing event, where he contributed to raising awareness of youth homelessness through both creative and team-based activities.

Roanin further expanded his skills through a pilot work experience program with the Northern Territory Fire and Emergency Service. This hands-on experience broadened his understanding of potential career pathways and strengthened his confidence in a professional environment.

Following this, Roanin was invited to interview for a warehouse role with Metcash. He approached the opportunity well prepared and was offered a part-time position. Within just two weeks, his strong work ethic and positive attitude saw him transition into a full-time role.

As noted by Metcash Darwin Branch General Manager Jennie Collis, *"Roanin was very prepared, enthusiastic and eager to learn"*. She further shared that he is now *"a polite, dedicated and hardworking young man... an integral part of our Independent Grocers team."*

Roanin now works with increasing independence, demonstrating strong attention to detail and operating equipment such as an Electronic Pallet Jack as part of his role. His journey reflects the impact of consistent support, real-world experience and the confidence that comes from being given the opportunity to succeed.



**Roanin
Encompass**



Career Launchpad

Supporting young people
with disability into
meaningful employment.

- Increased confidence, independence and work-readiness in participants.
- Successful transition from school into employment or further training.



Career Launchpad

A Year Defined by Excellence in Education and Employment

Career Launchpad provides structured support for young people transitioning from school into employment, further education and independent living. In 2025, YouthWorX NT made the strategic decision to self-fund the program, ensuring its continuation and impact for young people during this critical transition period.

The 2025 cohort commenced in January with 25 participants, referred through schools, families, community organisations and student re-engagement services. Throughout the year, participants engaged in weekly workshops, one-on-one coaching, volunteering, work experience placements, industry tours and accredited training opportunities. Program activities focused on building essential life and employment skills, including communication, self-advocacy, budgeting, resume development, interview preparation and workplace expectations.

Industry engagement was a key strength of the program, with visits to workplaces including Bunnings, Woolworths and the Darwin Convention Centre, giving participants practical insight into different career pathways and work environments.

Participants accessed a range of training opportunities, with the majority completing a Certificate I in Developing Independence, focused on work readiness, confidence building and independent living skills. Additional pathways included Certificate I qualifications in Automotive and Engineering, IT internship programs, White Card and First Aid training, as well as participation in DriveSafe NT to obtain their learner licences.

Work experience continued to be a critical component, with placements across a range of local employers including Bunnings, Little Miss Flowers, NT Motorcycles, NT Fasteners, Kinetic IT and Woolworths. These experiences provided participants with valuable exposure to workplace expectations and helped build confidence in real-world settings.

Volunteering was an important part of the Career Launchpad experience, giving participants practical opportunities to build confidence, strengthen workplace habits and contribute to the Darwin community.

Through regular support for organisations including Foodbank, RSPCA and St Vinnies, and involvement in major community events, participants developed teamwork, reliability and a stronger sense of connection beyond the classroom.

Several participants transitioned into employment during the year, securing roles with organisations including Metcash, McDonald's, KFC and Tri-Tek. Others progressed into further education, specialist programs such as CareerStart Digital, or into the Encompass program with NDIS support as they continued their pathway toward employment.

A significant highlight was Career Launchpad being named the **winner of the Excellence in Education and Employment category at the 2025 NT NDS Disability Inclusion Awards**. This recognition reflects the strength of the program and its impact in supporting young people to build confidence, independence and meaningful employment pathways.

The program concluded with a graduation event attended by families, employers and community partners, where 21 participants successfully completed their Certificate I in Developing Independence.

Career Launchpad fills an important gap for young people transitioning from school into work. The program provides practical learning, work experience and mentoring, helping participants build confidence and independence as they take their next step.



Introducing Zeikyl

Building Confidence, Building a Career: Zeikyl's Story

Zeikyl joined the Career Launchpad program at the start of 2025 after relocating from Western Australia and finding school a challenge. At just 15, he faced a number of personal barriers, but remained focused on his goal of working in construction.

Throughout the program, Zeikyl consistently engaged in workshops, coaching and volunteering activities, approaching every opportunity with a positive attitude and willingness to learn. He also attended Palmerston Youth Skills Centre one day per week, successfully completing a Certificate I in Engineering by the end of the year.

Midway through the program, Zeikyl experienced personal challenges that interrupted his progress. With support from his Youth Development Coach, he re-engaged, refocused on his goals and took

practical steps toward employment. This included identifying employers, building his resume, practicing interview skills and approaching workplaces.

Zeikyl also worked through key barriers to employment, updating his White Card, setting up banking access and securing a mobile phone, building the foundations to take on opportunities as they came.

His persistence paid off. After approaching employers in the Pinelands area, Zeikyl was invited to interview with Tri-Tek and offered a casual labouring role in their metal fabrication workshop. Following completion of his training, Zeikyl transitioned successfully into full-time employment.

Early feedback from his employer has been very positive, highlighting his punctuality, strong work ethic and positive attitude in the workplace, as shared by Tri-Tek's Elliot Brice: *"Zeikyl rocked up to our workshop, resume in hand. I was immediately impressed by the initiative of this young fella... Little over an hour later we were having an interview. Zeikyl has risen to the challenges of the role and always seems to have a smile on his face while working. He has proved to be mature beyond his years and is learning quickly."*

Zeikyl also completed his Certificate I in Developing Independence through YouthWorX NT. His journey reflects the impact of consistent support, skill development and determination in overcoming barriers to employment.

Tri-Tek is now exploring an apprenticeship pathway for Zeikyl, reflecting his progress and the strong future ahead of him.

Zeikyl, your determination and growth are a credit to you, and we look forward to seeing what you achieve next.



Zeikyl
Career Launchpad

CareerStart Digital

Equipping young people with IT skills and experience

- Participants gained hands-on industry experience with local ICT employers.
- Developed job-ready digital skills through mentoring and training.



CareerStart Digital



CareerStart Digital: From Learning to Employment

In 2025, YouthWorX NT successfully completed the third and final CareerStart Digital cohort funded through Google.org, marking the conclusion of the pilot phase of the program.

This cohort supported 15 neurodiverse young people, with 14 completing the program and transitioning into employment, further education or ongoing training pathways.

Participants undertook the Google IT Support Professional Certificate alongside structured work readiness and life skills development, equipping them for entry into the ICT sector and building confidence in workplace settings.

A key focus in 2025 was strengthening employment outcomes and deepening industry engagement. Participants undertook structured work placements with local ICT employers, gaining hands-on experience and developing professional networks that supported their transition into work.

Several secured traineeships and employment, including roles with NEC Australia, while others progressed into further study or supported pathways.

Across the full program period (2023–2025), CareerStart Digital supported 45 participants with a 95.6% completion rate, with all cohorts completing within the 8-month delivery timeframe.

All participants except one from the first cohort have remained living and working in the Northern Territory, demonstrating strong local retention.

Of the 43 graduates, 60% secured full-time employment in the ICT industry, while 40% transitioned into other sectors, related study or further training pathways. A further 10% continued into additional YouthWorX NT programs to extend their learning and development.

The success of the final cohort reinforced both the demand for CareerStart Digital and its effectiveness in supporting neurodiverse young people into meaningful employment pathways. YouthWorX NT extends its sincere thanks to Google.org for its investment in the program, which enabled the delivery of an innovative and impactful pilot with lasting outcomes for participants.

Following the pilot, YouthWorX NT advocated for continuation, resulting in Northern Territory Government funding for 12 months. This enabled the next phase of CareerStart Digital to commence, with a new cohort beginning in October 2025, ensuring ongoing ICT pathways for young people.



CareerStart Digital



Angus, Duke, Emanouel and Jett's Stories:

Angus joined the program with a goal to secure a traineeship and build his confidence in the IT industry. Through workshops, work experience and completion of Google's IT Support Professional Certificate, he developed both technical skills and workplace readiness.

Following the program, Angus secured a traineeship with NEC, where he is now applying his skills in a real-world environment and continuing to build his career in IT.

Duke entered the program with a strong interest in technology but limited confidence in how to enter the industry. Through a combination of technical training and practical experience, he developed the skills and confidence needed to pursue employment. Duke successfully secured a traineeship with NEC and is now continuing to build his capability and experience within the IT sector.

Emanouel joined the program seeking a clear pathway into the IT industry. With support from the program, he completed his IT certification and undertook a work placement with NEC.

His strong performance led to an offer of a traineeship, providing him with a clear and sustainable pathway into employment in the IT sector.

Jett joined the program with an interest in IT but limited exposure to the industry. Through hands-on learning and workplace experience, he developed both technical skills and an understanding of professional work environments.

Jett secured an IT apprenticeship with Santos, where he is now gaining valuable experience and building a long-term career pathway in the industry.

Group 3
CareerStart Digital



CareerStart Engineering-Pathways



CareerStart Engineering Pathways: From Training to Trade

CareerStart Engineering Pathways, delivered in partnership with Charles Darwin University (CDU), supported 12 young people to complete the RII20120 Certificate II in Resources and Infrastructure Work Preparation.

The program was funded through NTG Skills NT following engagement with the NT Manufacturing Council, who identified a need to build a stronger pipeline of entry-level workers for local employers across the manufacturing and construction sectors.

The cohort included a strong representation of First Nations participants (10 of 12), with 9 participants successfully completing the program despite a range of personal challenges impacting retention.

Participants engaged in a combination of accredited training and practical, hands-on learning, including workshop-based experience using welding equipment and power tools. This was complemented by work readiness workshops and one-on-one coaching to support confidence, workplace behaviour and long-term engagement.

Industry exposure remained a key component, with participants undertaking workplace tours and work experience placements with employers including Akron and Jaytex. These experiences provided direct insight into construction and manufacturing environments and helped build connections with potential employers.

Strong employment outcomes were achieved following completion. Participants transitioned into roles with WorkPac (ESS) as a Forklift Operator, Northtrack Machinery as an Apprentice Diesel Fitter, TrafficWerX NT as a Traffic Controller, and Airducter through a traineeship. Others progressed into retail employment, returned to school to complete Year 12, or commenced further training pathways.

The program demonstrates the impact of combining accredited training, targeted support and direct industry engagement to create practical pathways into employment.



Introducing Dwayne



Dwayne's Story: From Skills to Apprenticeship

Dwayne joined the CareerStart Engineering program from Batchelor with a clear goal of gaining the skills needed to secure an apprenticeship. Having never worked before, he demonstrated strong commitment from the outset, relocating to Darwin to participate in the program.

Throughout the six-month program, Dwayne consistently engaged in training and quickly developed his practical skills, particularly in welding. Over time, he grew in confidence, transitioning from a quiet participant into a capable and self-assured young person. Following graduation, Dwayne secured an apprenticeship with Airducter, marking a significant milestone in his pathway into the engineering industry.

Dwayne's journey reflects the impact of opportunity, commitment and practical skills development in supporting young people to achieve their employment goals.



**Dwayne
CareerStart Engineering Pathways**



Rural Young Leaders

Building leadership skills for young people with disability.

- Developed leadership and advocacy skills in young participants.
- Fostered connection and inclusion within a supportive community.



Rural Young Leaders

Supporting Tomorrow's Leaders

Following its launch in late 2024, the Rural Young Leaders Program (RYLP) continued into 2025, supporting a cohort of 10 young people to build leadership capability, confidence and employment readiness.

Delivered in partnership with Children and Young People with Disability Australia (CYDA), the program remained grounded in CYDA's national framework while responding to the local context and needs of young people in the Northern Territory. We acknowledge CYDA for their leadership and ongoing support in strengthening the program's impact.

Participants engaged in a structured program of workshops, experiential learning and community engagement. Sessions focused on goal setting, workplace expectations and advocacy, alongside practical life skills such as cooking and independent living.

The program provided strong exposure to civic, workplace and community environments. Participants undertook a tour of Parliament House to build their understanding of democratic processes and attended a workplace rights session delivered by the Australian Human Rights Commission. Industry engagement included workplace tours with Woolworths and Bunnings, offering insight into retail employment pathways.

Additional experiences included a guest speaker session with Dr Dinesh Palipana, a mental health and wellbeing session with headspace, and a tour of Government House hosted by His Honour Hugh Heggie, Administrator of the Northern Territory. These opportunities broadened participants' understanding of leadership and advocacy.

Through this combination of structured learning and real-world exposure, participants developed confidence, communication skills and a clearer understanding of their future pathways. Several participants progressed into further YouthWorX NT programs and ongoing leadership opportunities within their communities.



Connect Diverse Ability

Partnering to build inclusive employment opportunities in the NT.

- Delivered training and mentoring to local employers, increasing confidence in employing young people with disability.
- Strengthened pathways to meaningful work experience and employment through inclusive workplace practices.



Connect Diverse Ability

Creating Confident and Inclusive Employers

YouthWorX NT continued to strengthen inclusive employment pathways through the Connect Diverse Ability program, working in partnership with the Australian Human Rights Commission's IncludeAbility – Equality at Work team and employers across the Northern Territory.

In March 2025, the IncludeAbility – Equality at Work team delivered a series of in-person training sessions in Darwin, engaging employers from government, industry and community organisations to build confidence and capability in employing young people with disability.

A key focus of this work has been sustained engagement with the Northern Territory Government Early Careers team, advocating for structured employment pathways for young people with disability within the public sector. This advocacy has strengthened relationships across government and laid the groundwork for ongoing collaboration.

YouthWorX NT is also working with the IncludeAbility – Equality at Work team to co-design a Train the Trainer model. This approach will enable local delivery of employer training, including by staff and people with lived experience, supporting the long-term sustainability of this work beyond the current funding period.



Capacity Building

Supporting people to grow, connect and thrive

YouthWorX NT continued to deliver a range of targeted initiatives in 2025 designed to respond to emerging needs, test new approaches and strengthen pathways into employment for young people across the Northern Territory. These initiatives reflect our ability to work flexibly across systems, partnering with government, industry and community to address gaps and create practical opportunities.



Capacity Building

NTG Early Careers Pilot Program

The NTG Early Careers Pilot Program provided structured work experience opportunities for six young people with disability through partnerships with Northern Territory Government departments.

This pilot was developed through ongoing advocacy and collaboration under the Connect Diverse Ability program, working closely with the NTG Early Careers team to establish practical pathways into public sector employment.

Participants undertook placements across agencies including the Department of Education, Office of the Commissioner for Public Employment, Department of Corporate and Digital Development, NT Fire and Emergency Service and Department of Children and Families.

The program provided valuable exposure to public sector employment, enabling participants to build confidence, develop workplace skills and explore career pathways within government. The pilot was positively received by both participants and host agencies and represents an important first step in developing more structured and ongoing employment pathways, with further development planned for 2026.

Holtze Youth Detention Centre Programs

YouthWorX NT continued delivery of employment readiness and life-skills training within Holtze Youth Detention Centre, supporting young people to prepare for transition into employment and further training pathways.

In 2025, 57 structured workshops were delivered, focusing on employability, practical skills and personal development. A key outcome was the completion of White Card certification by over 60 participants, providing a recognised pathway into the construction industry.

Additional full-day workshops were delivered for young people on day release, including career readiness sessions, industry engagement with GTNT and practical activities such as building planter boxes and goal setting. Six young people participated in these sessions.

This work continues to play a critical role in supporting young people to build confidence, develop job-ready skills and establish positive pathways following release.

Capacity Building

Continued...

REEL SKILLS 2025

With continued support through a Recreational Fishing Grant from the Northern Territory Government, YouthWorX NT once again delivered the Reel Skills Initiative at Barramundi Adventures, bringing together 35 young people with disability for a day of outdoor learning, connection and fun.

Participants received their own fishing rod and shirt, learned practical fishing skills from local experts, and enjoyed a live cooking demonstration.

The program continued to deliver strong outcomes, with participants reporting increased confidence, greater enjoyment of group activities and a growing interest in outdoor recreation. Building on the success of the initiative, fishing remains a regular and valued part of YouthWorX NT's inclusive program activities.



Community Investment Committee

The Greater Darwin Community Investment Committee (CIC) continued to play a key role in 2025 as a platform for collaboration across employers, government, youth and community organisations, focused on strengthening employment pathways for young people.

Throughout the year, CIC brought together stakeholders to address shared challenges and align efforts across the region. Ongoing priorities included transport access, workforce development and strengthening connections between education and employment, with continued advocacy around barriers such as driver licensing and access to training pathways. This work also responded to emerging workforce demand across industries, reinforcing the need for coordinated, place-based responses.

A major milestone in 2025 was the launch of the NT Youth Employer Toolkit. Developed through CIC collaboration, the Toolkit provides practical guidance for employers to support inclusive youth hiring and strengthen entry-level pathways into the workforce. Its release represents a significant step toward improving employer confidence and creating more accessible opportunities for young people across the Territory.

YouthWorX NT was also proud to participate in the PLACE National Listening Tour, with the CIC recognised as part of a national showcase of effective place-based initiatives. This engagement provided an opportunity to contribute to national conversations while highlighting the Northern Territory context and strengthening local collaboration.

Building into 2026



In late 2025, YouthWorX NT commenced a new program that will continue to grow and deliver impact into 2026 and beyond, expanding our capacity to support young people across the Northern Territory.

EmployMeNT commenced in October 2025 at Charles Darwin University's Danala Campus, following establishment work in partnership with CDU under NT Government Skilling Pathways funding.

The program supports 12 young people to undertake a Certificate II in Workplace Skills, combining accredited training with structured employability support. Participants engaged in workshops focused on communication, teamwork, time management and professional behaviour, alongside individual coaching.

Industry exposure formed a key part of the program, with participants attending workplace tours and sessions with employers including Hilton, Bunnings, Woolworths Darwin and the Darwin Convention Centre, as well as engagement with GTNT. These experiences provided practical insight into workplace expectations and career pathways.

The program will continue into 2026, supporting participants to transition into employment, traineeships and further education.



Inclusive Employment Australia (IEA) commenced in November 2025, establishing a new disability employment service focused specifically on young people aged 15-25 across Darwin and Alice Springs.

The initial phase focused on program establishment, including recruitment of a dedicated team, setup of service delivery systems and building strong local engagement across both regions. YouthWorX NT has taken a deliberate approach to delivery, focusing specifically on supporting young people and working to our strengths in youth development, employment readiness and employer engagement.

Early engagement with employers and stakeholders has supported the development of disability-inclusive employment pathways, alongside the establishment of tailored, participant-led support.

Participant commencements were gradual during the final quarter of 2025, reflecting the timing of program settings, with increased engagement anticipated from early 2026.

The program will continue to expand in 2026, supporting participants through job preparation, skills development, employer engagement and ongoing post-placement support, while working with employers to create inclusive and sustainable employment opportunities.



Finance Summary

The Year Ended 31 December 2025

The 2025 financial year was a difficult but important year for YouthWorX NT. The organisation recorded a deficit of \$901,432. This was not the result we would aim for in an ordinary year, but it reflects clear decisions made by the Board to continue supporting young people, staff and essential programs during a period of reduced income and organisational change.

Revenue was lower than the previous year, mainly due to reduced grant and contracted income. Rather than scale back every area of work, YouthWorX NT chose to continue delivering services where the need was clear. This included self-funding the Career Launchpad program for the full year, so young people could keep accessing practical support to build skills, confidence and pathways into work.

The deficit was also affected by increased staffing costs and the relocation to new premises. These costs placed pressure on cash reserves, but they were tied to the organisation's ability to keep delivering safe, consistent and useful programs. The new premises and fit-out also provide a better base for future service delivery and partnerships.

We are mindful that reserves are there to support the organisation's purpose, not to sit untouched while important work stops. At the same time, they must be managed carefully. The Board and Finance, Audit and Risk Management Committee monitored the financial position closely throughout the year and will continue to focus on sustainable income, cost control and rebuilding reserves.

YouthWorX NT finished the year with some financial pressure, but also with stronger foundations than the result alone suggests. The task ahead is clear: keep backing programs that work, secure the income needed to sustain them and continue using our resources responsibly for the benefit of young people across the Northern Territory.





Finance Summary

The Year Ended 31 December 2025



Income Statement

Category	2025 (\$)	2024 (\$)
Income		
Grants & contributions	792,728	1,590,699
Interest income	72,080	87,146
Other revenue	669,952	436,006
Total Revenue	1,534,760	2,113,851
Expenses		
Employee benefits	1,408,338	1,165,104
Depreciation & amortisation	133,180	52,722
All other expenses	894,674	815,794
Total expenses	2,436,192	2,033,620
Net surplus/(deficit)	-901,432	80,231

Balance Sheet

Category	2025 (\$)	2024 (\$)
Assets		
Total current assets	4,006,393	5,233,796
Total non-current assets	716,372	825,074
Total assets:	4,722,765	6,058,870
Liabilities		
Total current liabilities	521,950	881,479
Total non-current liabilities	504,213	579,357
Total liabilities	1,026,163	1,460,836
Net Assets/ Equity	3,696,602	4,598,034

Funding summary

\$792,728

Grants & Contributions

\$72,080

Interest Income

\$669,952

Other Revenue

We'd like to thank all our Stakeholders for their generous support



Acknowledgements to the people who make it possible!

We extend our heartfelt thanks to our dedicated Board members, passionate team, valued employers and generous funders for your unwavering support throughout the year.

Your belief in our purpose and commitment to young people have been instrumental in creating real, lasting change. Together, we've helped young people build confidence and access real opportunities in our community - thank you for being a vital part of the YouthWorX NT journey.

Our Funders & Key Partners

We extend our sincere thanks to our funding partners for their generous support and belief in our work. Their investment has been crucial in enabling us to deliver impactful programs, create opportunities for young people, and drive meaningful change across our communities. We deeply value these partnerships and the shared commitment to empowering young Territorians to thrive.



Australian Government
Department of Employment
and Workplace Relations



Australian Government
Department of Social Services



Children and Young People
with Disability Australia



Brotherhood
of St Laurence



**Australian
Human Rights
Commission**



IncludeAbility



Our Board

we sincerely thank our Board Members for their ongoing support, leadership, and commitment to our purpose. Their guidance and diverse expertise have been vital in strengthening Youthworx NT's impact across the Northern Territory.



Peter De Jonge
Chairperson



Terry Lawler
Deputy Chairperson



James Burke
Treasurer



Kathryn Stenson
Board Member



Melanie Brenton
Board Member



Michelle Leonard
Board Member



Ronan Mackey
Board Member



Michelle Barton
Chief Executive Officer



Lisa Blakeley
Board Member
(appointed May 2025)



Patrik Ralph
Board Member
(appointed Nov 2025)



Graeme Sawyer
(resigned Feb 2025)



Carla Khasakhlah
(resigned Feb 2025)

Our Team

we extend a huge thanks to the entire Youthworx NT team for their passion, professionalism and tireless work throughout the year. Their ability to adapt, collaborate, and deliver high-quality support and programs is at the heart of everything we achieve. It is their everyday dedication that continues to shape a stronger, more inclusive future for young people.



Michelle Barton
Chief Executive Officer



Robyne Brouwer
Finance & Corporate
Manager



Scott Smith
Program Coordinator



Tanya Pederick
Program Coordinator



Kristy-Anne Obst
IEA Team Leader



Zac Luis
Youth Development
Coach / Trainer



Rikki Dehne
Youth Development
Coach



Amealia Schneider
Employer Engagement
Officer



David-Lee Nielson
Youth Development
Coach



Rory Ross
Youth Development
Coach



Renee Oster
Administration
Officer



Sebastian Ochoa Cuartas
Youth Development
Coach



Emma Westwood
Youth Development
Coach



Arittra Islam
Youth Development
Coach



Lyle Markham
Program Support
Trainee



Jack James
Youth Support
Worker



Michael Stergos
Receptionist/Admin
Trainee



Frazer Brooks
Youth Development
Coach



Niccolo Maffezzoni
Employer Engagement
Officer

Thank you for your support!

YouthWorX NT

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